



battleship
Aurora

Revolutionary hero

DATE UNKNOWN

In this painting for a poster from the 1917 Revolution period, Lenin appears in front of the battleship *Aurora*, which was used in the Bolshevik seizure of power.



Red horsemen

c. 1920

The 1917 revolution was followed by the Russian Civil War, between the Bolsheviks and the "White" armies led by czarist officers. This poster is dedicated "to the peoples of the Caucasus Red Army."

cavalry played an important part in Communist victory

SOVIET PROPAGANDA

ART FOR THE FURTHERANCE OF COMMUNIST POLITICAL IDEOLOGY AND REVOLUTIONARY IDEALS

For the Communists who seized power in Russia in November 1917, art had to serve the socialist revolution and disseminate its ideology. Propaganda mobilized the populace in support of the regime and pilloried its enemies.

During the early phase of Communist rule, many avant-garde artists believed their revolutionary ways of making art would accord with the political revolution. However, under the dictatorship of Joseph Stalin, from the late 1920s Soviet artists were required to depict workers and peasants in a heroic-realist style, their images reflecting the supposed happiness and progress of Communist life.



Modernist poster 1919

Avant-garde artist El Lissitzky produced this Civil War poster. His red wedge represents the Communist Red Army beating the anti-Communist White armies.

The Revolution needs you 1928

The labor force underwent radical reorganization under the Communists. This poster urges Soviet citizens to become members of workers' cooperatives.



Rapid industrialization 1928

The Communist leadership launched an industrialization drive in the late 1920s. Workers are compelled to increase production by this poster.

